

Similar to *B. nutans*, but produces broader, spreading, gray-green leaves and larger bracts. Tubular, green flowers, with purple tips and red margins, are borne in summer. Z9–15 27°C

Biota orientalis. See *Platycladus orientalis*.
Bistorta. See *Persicaria*.

BLECHNUM

BLECHNACEAE

Genus of evergreen or semievergree ferns. Most species prefer semishade. Needs moist, neutral to acidic soil. Remove fading fronds regularly. Propagate *B. penna-marina* and *B. spicant* by division in spring, other species by spores in late summer.
B. alpinum. See *B. penna-marina* subsp. *alpinum*.
B. brasiliense ‘Volcano’. Evergreen, shuttlecock-shaped fern that eventually forms a small trunk. H 2–3ft (60–90cm), S 2ft (60cm). Has broadly lance-shaped fronds, deeply divided into narrow pinnae. New fronds emerging from the center are vivid red, maturing to dark green. Z6–10
B. chilense, syn. *B. tabulare* of gardens, illus. p.292.
B. penna-marina illus. p.290. **subsp. alpinum** (syn. *B. alpinum*) is an evergreen fern with creeping rhizomes. H 4–6in (10–15cm), S indefinite. Has tufts of linear, pinnate or pinnatifid, matte, dark green fronds, which are reddish green when young. Z10–11
B. spicant (Hard fern). Evergreen fern. H 8–20in (20–50cm), S 2ft (60cm) or more. Bears narrowly lance-shaped, deeply divided, ladderlike, leathery, spreading, dark green fronds. Prefers shade and peaty or leafy soil. Z10–11
B. tabulare of gardens. See *B. chilense*.

BLETILLA

ORCHIDACEAE

See also ORCHIDS.
B. hyacinthina. See *B. striata*.
B. striata, syn. *B. hyacinthina* (illus. p.466). Deciduous, terrestrial orchid. H and S 12–24in (30–60cm). In late spring or early summer, bears magenta or white flowers, 1¼in (3cm) long, and broadly lance-shaped leaves, 20in (50cm) long. Needs shade in summer. Z5–8

Bocconia cordata. See *Macleaya cordata*.

BOENNINGHAUSENIA

RUTACEAE

Genus of deciduous subshrubs, usually with soft, herbaceous stems, grown for their foliage and flowers. Cut to ground level in winter. Needs full sun and fertile, well-drained but not too dry soil. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer or by seed in fall.
B. albiflora. Deciduous, bushy subshrub. H and S 3ft (1m). Has pungent, dark green leaves, divided into ovate leaflets. Bears loose panicles of small, cup-shaped, white flowers in late summer. Z6–10

BOLAX

APIACEAE/UMBELLIFERAE

Genus of evergreen, hummock- and cushion-forming perennials, often included in *Azorella*. Grown for its symmetrical rosettes of small, thick, tough leaves. Flowers only rarely in cultivation. Suitable for growing in gritty screes, troughs, and alpine houses. Needs sun and humus-rich, well-drained soil. Propagate by rooting rosettes in spring.
B. gummifer illus. p.376.

BOMAREA

ALSTROEMERIACEAE

Genus of tuberous-rooted, usually deciduous, scrambling and twining climbers, grown for their flowers. Grow in well-drained soil in full light. Water regularly in growth, sparingly when dormant. Provide support. Some species grow well planted beneath shrubs through which they can climb; mulch to protect tubers before winter. Cut out old flowering stems at ground level when leaves yellow. Propagate by seed or division in early spring.
B. andimarcana, syn. *B. pubigera* of gardens. Deciduous, scrambling climber with straight, slender stems. H 6–10ft (2–3m). Has lance-shaped leaves, white and hairy beneath. Bears nodding, tubular, green-tipped, pale yellow flowers, suffused pink, in spring–fall. Z9–10
B. caldasii. See *B. multiflora*.
B. edulis illus. p.201.
B. kalbreyeri of gardens. See *B. multiflora*.
B. multiflora, syn. *B. caldasii*, *B. kalbreyeri* of gardens, illus. p.207.
B. pubigera of gardens. See *B. andimarcana*.
B. salsilla. Deciduous, herbaceous, twining climber. H to 6ft (2m), S 3ft (1m) or more. Ovate leaves are grayish-green. Bears open clusters of pendent, bell-shaped, green-tipped, cerise flowers in summer. Z9–11

BORAGO

Borage

BORAGINACEAE

Genus of annuals and perennials, grown for culinary use as well as for their flowers. Requires sun and fertile, well-drained soil. For culinary use, gather only young leaves. Propagate by seed sown outdoors in spring. Some species will self seed prolifically and may become invasive.
B. officinalis (Borage) illus. p.315. **f. alba** is a robust, freely branching annual. H 2ft (60cm), S 18in (45cm). Has lance-shaped to ovate, bristly, dull basal leaves and stalkless, lance-shaped stem leaves. Bears 5-petaled, star-shaped, white flowers all summer. Z6–10

BORONIA

RUTACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs, grown mainly for their flowers. Needs full light and sandy, neutral to acidic soil. Water potted plants moderately, less when not in full growth. For a compact habit, shorten long stems after flowering. Propagate by seed in

spring or by semiripe cuttings in summer. Red spider mite may be a problem.
B. megastigma illus. p.456.

BOUGAINVILLEA

NYCTAGINACEAE

Genus of deciduous or evergreen, woody-stemmed, scrambling climbers, grown for their large clusters of small, tubular flowers, which have showy bracts. Grow in fertile, well-drained soil and in full light. In growing season, water moderately; keep pot plants almost dry when dormant. Tie to a support. Cut back previous season’s lateral growths in spring, leaving ¾–1¼in (2–3cm) long spurs. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer or by hardwood cuttings when dormant. Whitefly and mealy bug may attack.
B. x buttiana. Vigorous, evergreen, woody-stemmed, scrambling climber. H 25–40ft (8–12m). Has ovate, mid-green leaves, to 3in (8cm) long, lighter below. Bears large clusters of strongly waved, golden-yellow, purple or red floral bracts from summer to fall. Z13–15. **‘California Gold’** see *B. x b.* **‘Enid Lancaster’**. **‘Crimson Lake’** see *B. x b.* **‘Mrs. Butt’**. **‘Enid Lancaster’** (syn. *B. x b.* **‘California Gold’**, *B. x b.* **‘Golden Glow’**) has orange-yellow floral bracts. **‘Golden Glow’** see *B. x b.* **‘Enid Lancaster’**. **‘Miss Manila’** (syn. *B.* **‘Miss Manila’**, *B.* **‘Tango’**) has pink floral bracts. **‘Mrs. Butt’** (syn. *B. x b.* **‘Crimson Lake’**) has crimson-magenta bracts. **‘Scarlet Queen’** has scarlet bracts.
B. ‘Dania’. Vigorous, mainly evergreen, woody-stemmed, scrambling climber. H to 15ft (5m). Has rounded-ovate, mid-green leaves; bears clusters of deep pink floral bracts in summer. Z12–15
B. glabra illus. p.462. **‘Sanderiana’** illus. p.462. **‘Snow White’** illus. p.460.
B. ‘Miss Manila’. See *B. x buttiana* **‘Miss Manila’**
B. spectabilis. Strong-growing, mainly evergreen, woody-stemmed, scrambling climber; stems usually have a few spines. H 22–40ft (7–12m). Has elliptic to ovate leaves and, in summer, large trusses of red-purple floral bracts. Z9–11
B. ‘Tango’. See *B. x buttiana* **‘Miss Manila’**.

Boussingaultia baselloides of gardens. See *Anredera cordifolia*.

BOUTELOUA

POACEAE/GRAMINEAE

See also GRASSES, BAMBOOS, RUSHES, and SEDGES.
B. gracilis, syn. *B. oligostachya* (Blue grama, Mosquito grass). Semievergreen, tuft-forming, narrow-leaved, perennial grass. H to 2ft (60cm), S 1ft (30cm). Comblike flower spikes, 1¼in (4cm) long, are held at right-angles to stems in summer. Z5–9
B. oligostachya. See *B. gracilis*.

BOUVARDIA

RUBIACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs and perennials, grown for their flowers. Prefers full light and fertile, well-drained soil. Water freely when in full growth, and moderately at other times. Cut back stems by half to

three-quarters after flowering. Propagate by softwood cuttings in spring or by greenwood or semiripe cuttings in summer. Whitefly and mealy bug may be troublesome.
B. humboldtii. See *B. longiflora*.
B. longiflora, syn. *B. humboldtii*. Erect to spreading shrub. H 3ft (1m), S 2ft (60cm). Has lance-shaped leaves and bears terminal clusters of fragrant, white flowers, with slender tubes and 4 petal lobes, from summer to early winter. Z13–15 (min. 41°F/5°C)
B. ternifolia, syn. *B. triphylla* (Scarlet trompetilla), illus. p.456.
B. triphylla. See *B. ternifolia*.

BOWIEA

ASPARAGACEAE

Genus of summer-flowering, bulbous, perennial succulents with scrambling, branched, green stems that produce no proper leaves. Needs sun and well-drained soil; plant with half of bulb above soil level. Support with sticks or canes. Propagate by seed sown under glass in winter or spring. May produce offsets.
B. volubilis. Bulbous summer-flowering succulent. H 12ft (4m), S indefinite. Has climbing, much-branched, slender stems and no proper leaves. Produces small, star-shaped, green flowers at tips of stems. Provide support. Z14–15 (min. 55°F/13°C)

BOYKINIA

SAXIFRAGACEAE

Genus of mound-forming perennials, grown for their foliage, sometimes bronze-tinted when young, and their flowers. Good for a wild or woodland garden. Most species require shade and humus-rich, moist but well-drained, acidic soil. Propagate by division in spring or by seed in fall.
B. aconitifolia. Mound-forming perennial. H 6–24in (15–60cm), S 12in (30cm). Rounded to kidney-shaped, broadly toothed leaves are glandular-hairy. In summer, flower stems bear very small, bell-shaped, white flowers with yellowish-white centers. Z5–9
B. jamesii, syn. *Telesonix jamesii*. Mound-forming, rhizomatous perennial. H and S 6in (15cm). Each woody stem has a rosette of kidney-shaped, glandular-hairy leaves with lacerated edges. In mid- and late spring, produces open bell-shaped, frilled, pink flowers with green centers. Z5–9
Brachytilum. See *Hedychium*.

BRACHYCHITON

MALVACEAE/STERCULIACEAE

Genus of evergreen or deciduous, mainly spring-and summer-flowering trees, grown for their flowers and overall appearance. Needs full light and humus-rich, well-drained, preferably acidic soil. Water containerized plants moderately, much less in winter. Prune if needed. Propagate by seed in spring. Red spider mite may be a nuisance.
B. acerifolius, syn. *Sterculia acerifolia*, (Illawarra flame tree), illus. p.450.
B. populneus, syn. *Sterculia diversifolia* (Kurrajong). Evergreen, conical tree, pyramidal when young. H 20–70ft (6–20m), S 10–20ft (3–6m). Pointed or 3–5 lobed,